

*Despite the late restart - after waiting for Matteo to arrive with the new wheel - and despite the intermittent snowfall, I begin to cover kilometers again. My mood is good once more, I'm motivated and my legs are rested, but out of caution I avoid singing... at least for now, considering what happened last time. I observe the landscape and the last isolated farms. In each one, a herd of horses watches me, and curious, they approach the fence as I pass - almost as if to greet me and wish me a good journey. They say that in Iceland there are more horses than humans; perhaps that's not entirely true, but since the beginning of the expedition I've certainly met more four-legged creatures than people. It's a unique breed found only in this country: small, curious, muscular - something between a pony and our classic horse. The sky opens completely and the day begins to fade. I want to take advantage of the last bit of light to make up for some lost time. Eventually I pass - without entering - a charming little settlement of breeders on a hill. I know it's the last cluster of houses along my route, and shortly after I decide to set up the tent. The night seems like it will be calm, but I secure every corner of the tent anyway; the weather in this land is unpredictable, and it's better not to be caught off guard. One of the best moments of the day comes when I light the stove to melt snow. The inside of the tent gradually warms up when the outside temperature isn't too low - like today, around zero degrees. At this hour I'm always incredibly hungry, so I enjoy a bit of everything with immense pleasure: bread, cheese, ham, chips, biscuits, dried fruit, and more. I accompany the food with the hot tea I have left, until I devour - as soon as it's ready - my first carbohydrate-based meal.*